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BUSN 198R

Internship Reflection

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This summer, I worked at ServiceNow as the employee communications intern. During the course of my 12-week internship I learned numerous valuable lessons through hands-on experience. I had the privilege of going-in person, since the office was located in Santa Clara. My internship was hybrid, which allowed me to go in-person 3 days a week, and work from home the remainder of the week. For the twelve-weeks that I worked, I worked M-Friday of each week.

During my internship I had the privilege to learn a variety of communication strategies. While I have learned valued lessons in the classroom, I found that being able to engage in hand-on corporate communications work was even more valuable. During the first week of my internship, the company did a great job throughout the onboarding process and helping students acclimate to a new corporate environment, especially since this was my first internship. The Early In Career team put together a handful of activities for interns, which included an off-site for the 300 hundred total interns the company employed, from across all their offices in the United States. Not only were these activities fun, but allowed me the opportunity to build my network at the very beginning of my internship.

Processing the onboarding process, I was able to jump in headfirst and get to work. I luckily had a great manager and a great team who wanted to help me learn and grow, but also sought my opinions and insights in respect to projects. There was main distinction about my internship, that did not look the same as other internships. On the employee comms team that I was on, I was the only intern, whereas the finance team had 6 interns for the one team. Not only was being the only intern a great honor but I was able to personalize my experience whatever way I choose to. At first, I struggled with understanding the ways in which this specific company and team worked. I struggled to realize that a corporate communications setting drastically differed from a classroom. In the classroom, there are clear assignments with noted due dates. In a corporate setting, there is no Camino pages or someone telling you step-by-step instructions. This was something that I had to learn and ask about. Whether that be in a meeting asking for clear clarification on what is expected from me or asking when they need this by.

I also had to change my approach in regards to writing and communication. While each company may do things differently, this company had a specific way for their communication styles. They mainly used slide decks to communication across the internal team and also cross functionally. The environment on the team was also relaxed, so Microsoft teams was greatly used, as well as Outlook for a more formal conversation, if not, in-person or via Zoom.

I would also like to note the company culture. The culture of the company is built on winning as a team, and helping company's work better, it being an AI workflow company. The culture on this specific team, the employee comms team, was more than a team but a group that supported one another and encouraged building relationships and individuality. During my first week on this team, I was asked if I had any days planned to take off during my internship, showing that while work is greatly important, so is your mental health and wellbeing. There will

always be work, but it is easy to forget to take time for yourself. So, in addition to the 2 days I was able to take off this summer, the whole company marked paid days off for all employees. Whether that be for a national holiday, like Juneteenth or Labor Day, wellness days were also marked. I think this was a great way for the company as a whole to show their continued efforts and support to all employees. My specific team, did not conduct any meetings on Fridays, allowing employees to catch up on their emails and have a nice start to the weekend.

During my internship, I worked on 12 different projects, instead of just one singular project. Some of my projects included:

- Help archive old comms content by cleaning up the teams OneDrive
- Explore new ways the team can use AI/Gen AI on the team
- Create a guide for in-person events, an operational manual, in order to drive operational excellence across the employee events team
- Assist with cultural moments and other milestone employee experiences. Lead plans for select cultural moments.

While this is not all the work I did this summer, I had the exposure to so much more. Whether that be getting behind a camera to help create a compelling and inspiring employee showcase, to being able to attend and assist at a leadership conference with members of the executive board in San Francisco. Especially, being able to see corporate events come to life, excited me. Event planning is something I have a passion for, and I previously had the opportunity to create my own operational guide for my involvement in a off-campus organization.

After wrapping up my internship and gaining valuable hands-on experience, there were several lessons that stood out to me, and something that I plan to translate to the remaining of my

time at SCU, and as I go into the workforce post-graduation. First, I learned that it is okay to ask questions. When I came into my internship, I was scared that I could not ask small, some might say dumb, questions about what is expected of me or when things should be handed in, but that was not the case. The team allowed me to feel comfortable to ask these questions which ultimately allowed me to grow even more. I also learned what quality of work is expected in a corporate communications setting. Since I was working with some of the best communicators in the Bay Area, there is a high bar. That means, learning about the feedback deadlines and planning accordingly, and also the ability to pivot at any notice. My favorite aspect of employee communications was there is no correct way to do something, if something does not work you are able to pivot, make appropriate changes, and make a new plan.

While this company was not a typical retailer company like Nike or Sephora, it did sell a product. ServiceNow is a cloud-based software company that enables businesses to automate and manage digital workflows across company's and teams. The company creates easy to use interfaces that allow for this seamless transition whether that be for transporting files or explaining the respective company's mission to the customers. This AI platform allows for seamless data flow, and allows companies to easily digitize any process across their organization.

As I look into the future, I hope to continue working in the internal communications sector. I have found the work exciting, not cut and paste, and something that serves employees internally. In internal comms, and specifically employee communications, you are able to see your hard work pay off through feedback, positive or negative affirmations, and even praise.